

Brute Force Activity Report

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Findings

- Time: 2026-09-11 19:09:32 UTC to 2026-09-11 19:26:31 UTC
- Host Machines:
 - SOC-FW-RDP
 - SHIR-Hive
 - SHIR-SAP
- Affected Accounts:
 - ADMINISTRATOR
 - administrator
 - admin
- IOC Domains: Unknown/Not present in Telemetry
- IOC IP's: Unknown/Not present

Investigation Summary

An alert triggered of potential brute force activity and prompted investigation of the potential brute force across the organization's Infrastructure. The activity began on 09/11/2026 at 19:09:32 UTC and ended on 09/11/2026 at 19:26:31 UTC with numerous failed logins towards the ADMINISTRATOR, admin, and administrator user accounts. Based on the investigation, and the telemetry available, we cannot determine if the activity is ongoing; however, the activity correlates to automated brute force attempts based on the total number of events in the given timeline.

Investigation steps

To understand the timeline of events, I sorted by failed login events.

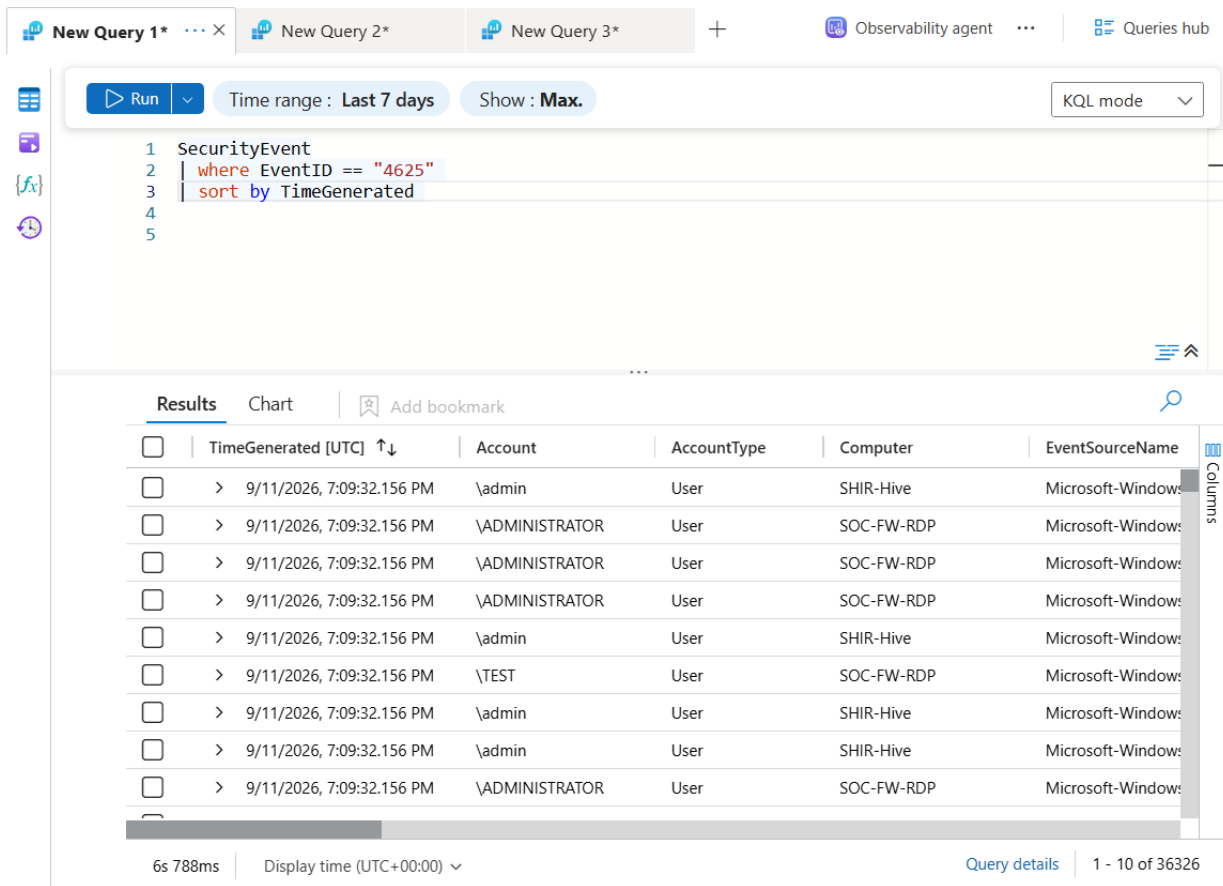


Figure 1: Scoping out entire events with failed logins.

Once I confirmed the number of failed logins, I began to filter based on the top 5 accounts with the most failed logins. I also correlated which accounts were failing to login to each machine. We can see the accounts pertaining to an administrator were attempted to login to.

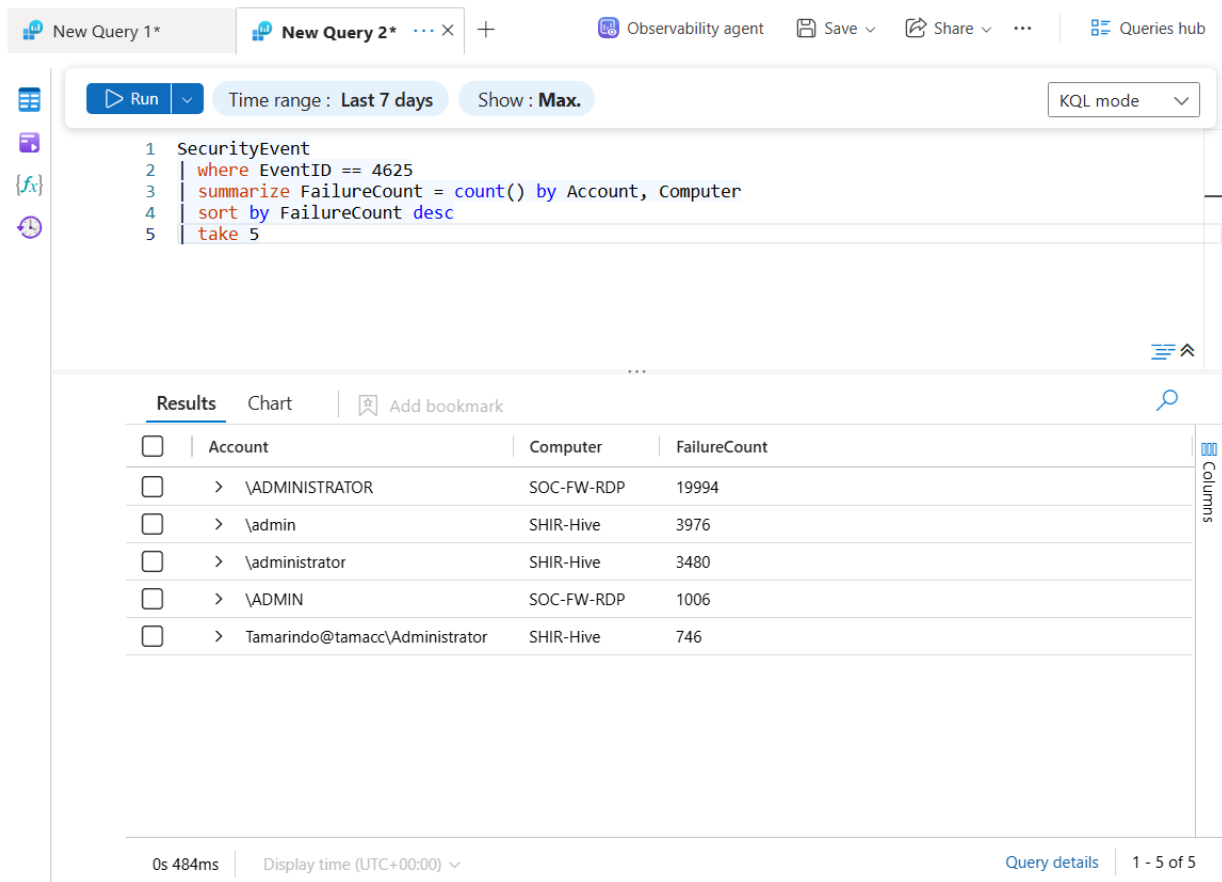


Figure 2: Identifying failed administrator logins by Computer.

Furthermore, to identify if any login attempts were successful, I filtered for successful logins by Account, and Computer. We can see successful logins, but they do not correlate with the current activity.

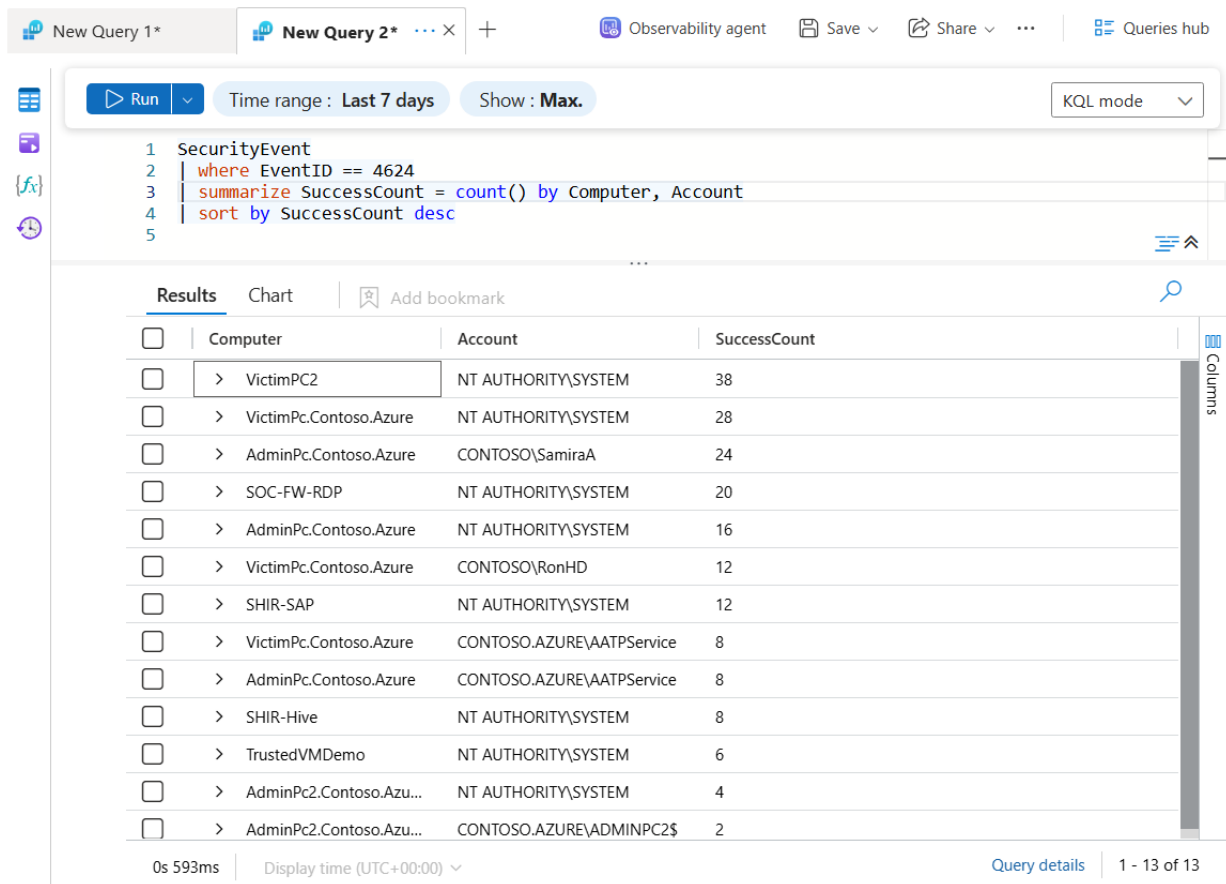


Figure 3: Finding Successful logins.

To confirm that the successful logins did not correlate with the current activity, I filtered for successful login attempts. We can see the successful logins, however, the account is a SYSTEM account login, which does not correlate with the activity, and is the built-in account when the OS boots.

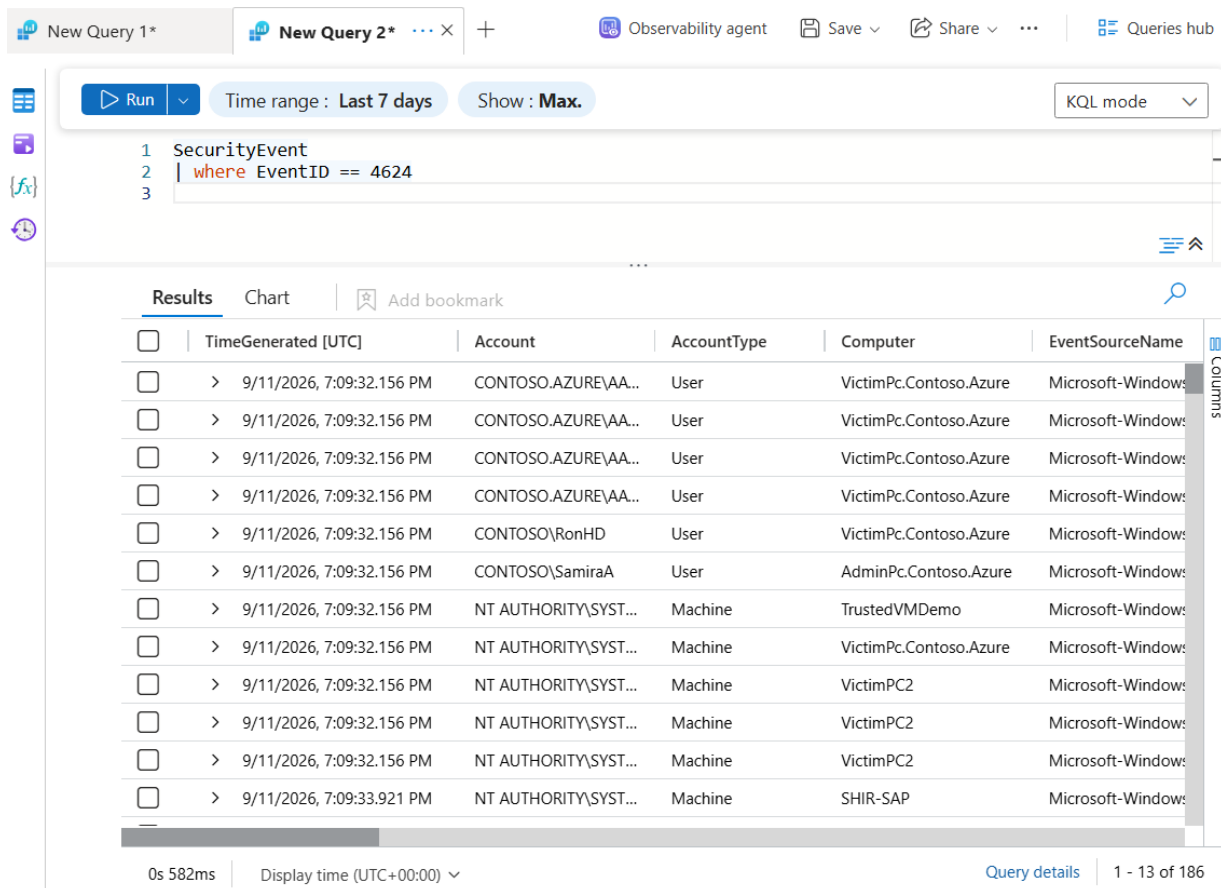


Figure 4: Reviewing correlation of login events.

Recommendations

- Determine if **SOC-FW-RDP** machine truly requires external RDP Access.
 - If external access is a requirement, enforce MFA, as well as the use of a VPN connection to reduce likelihood of Unauthorized logins.
- To prevent any successful login attempts, an account lockout policy should be enabled to prevent any automated login attempts.
 - For instance, craft a policy that enforces login attempts, as well as a duration to mitigate the likelihood of an unauthorized login.